

Reformation: undermining authority

The authority of the Church came under increasing pressure as secular Renaissance humanism spread across Europe. Papal authority was challenged by new secular rulers and governments, and advances in scientific discovery contradicted Catholic dogma. But it was not only pressure from outside the Church that brought about change; many within saw the Church as corrupt and remote from the people, especially in northern Europe. Martin Luther's *Ninety-five Theses*, a tirade against clerical abuses posted in 1517, sparked the Protestant Reformation and created a schism in the Church that was symptomatic of the mood of the time. With the invention of printing, access to information moved beyond the control of the Catholic Church, and the domination of medieval scholastic philosophy came to an end. The new humanist ideas were manifested at first in the cultural and artistic movement of the Renaissance, but also provided fertile ground for science and philosophy, culminating in the 18th-century 'Age of Reason' that marked the beginning of modern philosophy and science.

AMORE ET STUDIO ELVCIDANDAE
ueneris hac subscripſa diſponant Vuittenberge, Praſidēte
R. P. Martino Luther, Amū & S. Theologiae Magiſtro, cuius
deniq; ibidem lectore Ordinatio. Quare petit ut qui non poſ-
ſunt uerbis praefentes nobiſcum diſceptare, agant id literis ab-
ſentes, in nomine domini noſtri Ieſu Chriſti, Amen.



Omnis & Magiſter noſter Ieſus Chriſtus, di-
cendo poenitentia agite &c. omnem uitam ſi-
delium poenitentiam eſſe uoluit.

- ij Quod uerbū poenitentia de poenitentia ſacra-
mentali, i. confeſſionis & ſanctiſſationis quae
ſacerdotum miniſterio celebratur non po-
teſt intelligi.
iij Non tamen ſolū intēdit interiorē; immo interior nulla eſt, niſi
foris operetur uitae carnis mortificationes.
iiij Manet itaq; poena donec manet odium ſui, i. poenitentia uera
intus) ſcilicet uſq; ad introitum regni celorum.
v Papa non uult nec poteſt, ullas poenas remittere; praeter eas,
quas arbitrio uel ſuo uel canonum impoſuit.
vi Papa nō poteſt remittere ullam culpā, niſi declarādo & appro-
bando remiſſam a deo. Aut certe remittēdo caſus reſeruatōs
ſibi, quibus contēpſit culpa proſus remaneret.
vij Nulli proſus remittit deus culpam, quia ſimul cum ſubſiciat
humilitatem in omnibus ſacerdoti ſuo uicario,
viii Canones poenitētia ſolū uiuentibus ſunt impoſiti; niſi q;
moriturus, ſecundū eodem debet imponi.
ix Inde bene nobis facit ſpirituſ ſanctus in Papa; excipiendo in ſu-
is decretis ſemper amiculum mortis & neceſſitatis.
x Indocēte & male faciūt ſacerdotes ij, qui morituris poenitēcias
canonicas in purgatorium reſeruant.
xi Zizania illa de mutanda poena Canonica in poenā purgato-
rij, uidentur certe dormientibus Episcopis ſeminata.
xii Olim poenae canonicae nō poſt, ſed ante abſolutionem impo-
nebantur, tanq; tentamenta uerā contritiōis.

DISPUTATIO. DE VIRTUTE INDVLGEN.

- xij Morituri, per mortem omnia ſoluunt, & legibus canonū mor-
tui ſunt, habentes iure earū relaxationem.
xiiij Imperfecta ſanctas ſeu charitas morituri, neceſſario ſecum fert
magis timorem, q̄o q; maiorē, quāto minor fuerit ipſa.
xv Hic timor & horror, ſaris eſt, ſe ſolo (ut alia taceam) facere poe-
nam purgatorij, cum ſit proximis deſperationis horrore.
xvi Videntur, infernus, purgatorium, celum diſſerre; ſicut deſpe-
ratio, prope deſperatio, ſecuritas diſſerunt.
xvii Neceſſarium uidetur animabus in purgatorio ſicut minui hor-
rorem, ita augeri charitatem.
xviii Nec probatū uidetur illis, aut rationibus, aut ſcripturis, q; ſint
extra ſtatum meriti ſeu augendae charitatis.
xix Nec hoc probatū eſſe uidetur, q; ſint de ſua beatitudine certa
& ſecura, ſaltem oēs, licet nos certum ſimus.
xx Igī Papa per remiſſionē plenariā omnium poenarū, non ſimpli-
citer omnium intelligit, ſed a ſeipſo tūmodo impoſitarū.
xxi Errant itaq; indulgentiarū praedicatores ij, qui dicunt per Pa-
pae indulgentias, hominē ab omni poena ſolui & ſaluari.
xxii Quin nullam remittit animabus in purgatorio, quā in hac ui-
ta debuiffent ſecundum Canones ſoluere.
xxiii Si remiſſio ulla omnium omnino poenarū pōt alicui dari; certū
eſt eam nō niſi perfectiſſimis, i. pauciſſimis dari.
xxiiii Falli ob id neceſſe eſt, maiorem parē populi per indifferentē
illam & magnificam poenae ſoluae promiſſionem.
xxv Qualē poteſtatē habet Papa i purgatorij gēraliter talē habet
q; libet Episcopuſ & cura in ſua dioceſi, & parochia ſpāliter.
i Optime facit Papa, q; nō poteſtate clauis (quā nullam habet)
ſed per modum ſuffragij, dat animabus remiſſionem.
ii Homines praedicant, qui ſtaim, ut ſactus nūmus in ciſtam tē-
nuerit, euolare dicunt animam.
iij Certū eſt nūmo in ciſtam tinniente, augeri quēſtum & auidi-
ciam poſſe; ſuffragiū autē eccleſiae eſt in arbitrio dei ſolius.
iij Quis ſciſi omnes animae in purgatorio uelint redire, ſicut de
ſancto Seuerino & poſchali factum narratur.
v Nullus ſecurus eſt de ueritate ſuae contritiōis; multo minus
a ij

An extract from Luther's *Ninety-five Theses*.